

OSF × Andela Hackathon 2026 — Safety, Reporting & Protection

Ekyama

Speak safely. Be heard.

An anonymous reporting and support tool for survivors of abuse in Uganda — built for men and women alike.

THE PROBLEM

Male survivors have nowhere obvious to go

Uganda's GBV support tools and services are built almost entirely around women and children. Male survivors of rape, defilement and domestic abuse are left out — practically and legally.

The legal gap

Uganda's Penal Code (s.123) defines rape as an offence against a woman or girl. A male survivor cannot report a sexual assault as "rape" under that section.

The fear

Same-sex assault often falls under s.145, the same statute criminalising same-sex conduct — so reporting can risk exposing the survivor himself.

The result

Stigma plus legal risk plus no clear pathway means many male survivors — and many women too — simply don't report at all.

WHO IT'S FOR

Three people Ekyama is built around

A male survivor

Of domestic abuse or sexual assault, who may not know any service exists for him and fears not being believed, or legal exposure.

A female survivor

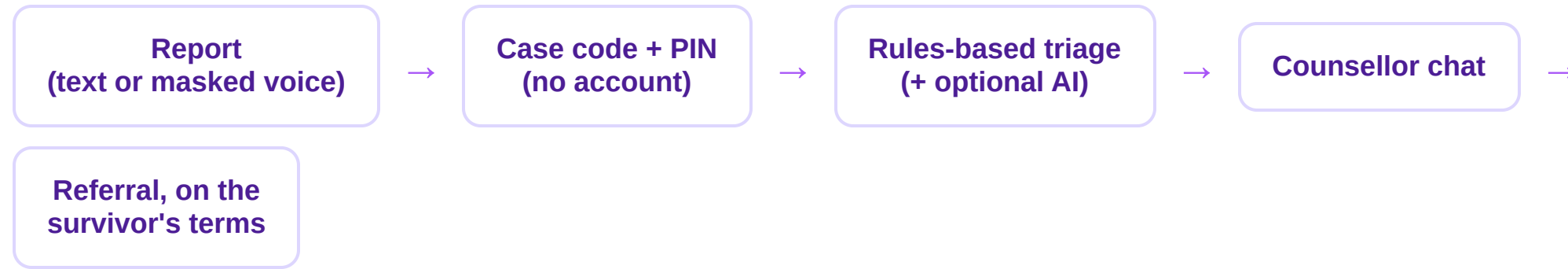
Of domestic abuse, rape or defilement-related concerns — including reporting on behalf of a child.

A counsellor

Triaging incoming reports by urgency, responding without ever seeing a survivor's identity unless the survivor chooses to share it.

THE SOLUTION

Report → be heard → get a real next step



No registration. No forced disclosure. A human counsellor is always the first step — police involvement is the survivor's choice, never the default.

Built for real conditions, not a demo

- **Voice masking on-device** — recordings are pitch-shifted in the browser; the original never leaves the phone.
- **Automatic PII scrubbing** — phone numbers, emails and ID numbers are stripped before anything is saved.
- **Sourced, dated information** — every hotline and legal note shows where it came from and when it was checked; unverified entries are labelled, never presented as fact.
- **Low-data mode** and a **quick-exit** button on every page.
- **English, Luganda, Kiswahili** — with a country-pack architecture so a second country is a data file, not a rewrite.

WHERE AI FITS

AI assists counsellors. It never talks to survivors.

"A rules-based floor always runs first. An optional AI pass can raise urgency for a counsellor's attention — it can never lower what the rules already flagged, and it never generates a message a survivor reads."

Rules-based triage

Always on. Flags danger signals: weapons, "right now", a child involved, and more — zero dependencies, zero API key required.

Optional free-tier AI

Sharpens the counsellor's brief. Fails silently back to rules if unavailable — the demo can't break on this path.

UNIQUENESS

What sets Ekyama apart

Feature	Typical GBV reporting tools	Ekyama
Who it's for	Framed around women and children	Men and women, explicitly
First contact	Often routes straight to police/institution	Human counsellor first, always
Legal framing	Generic	Country-specific — even catches Kenya vs. Uganda differing on who the rape law protects
Trust	Static info, no provenance	Sourced + dated on every entry
Scale	Hard-coded to one country	Two country packs shipped, switchable live

Two things most hackathon entries only put on a roadmap slide

Two countries, live today

Switch the header dropdown from Uganda to Kenya and the help directory, legal notes and even the available languages update everywhere at once — all from one JSON data file, no code change. It surfaced a real finding: Kenya's rape law is gender-neutral, Uganda's is not. The app now says so, instead of assuming one legal picture fits every country it expands to.

Works on a feature phone, demonstrably

Roughly 1 in 3 phones in the region is still a feature phone. /ussd-demo is a keypad-and-screen simulator that calls the exact same report and case-lookup APIs as the web app — not a mockup. A report submitted through 2 keypad presses shows up in the counsellor console exactly like a web submission. What's left for production is a telco gateway contract, not a rebuild.

Plus: the app installs to a home screen and keeps working offline for the pages survivors need most — verified by a real service worker, not a manifest alone.

Trustworthy isn't just a claim — it's checkable and it's reachable

A public numbers page

/stats shows real, live totals — reports received, the breakdown by urgency, status and country, and the median time to a counsellor's first reply — computed straight from the case database. No case codes, no narrative text, no locations, no per-case timestamps: only aggregates. An institution's responsiveness should be visible even when no individual report can be.

A simple view for every literacy level

One toggle swaps the home, report and help pages into large icons, tap-to-call hotline cards and icon buttons instead of paragraphs and radio labels — the same underlying flow and data, just far less reading required. The preference is remembered on the device, so it isn't a separate stripped-down app to maintain.

A low-friction first step for the least-served survivors

Piloted with an organisation like MOHRAU or the Uganda Police Child & Family Protection Unit as the receiving counsellor team, Ekyama gives male survivors — one of the least-served groups in the region's GBV response — a safe first point of contact, and gives every survivor visibility into what happens after they report.

Next: a real telco gateway

Wire /ussd - demo's proven flow to a live USSD short code via a provider like Africa's Talking.

Next: native-speaker review

Of Luganda strings, plus more local languages and a third country pack.

Next: per-counsellor accounts

Replacing the shared demo token with real accounts and audit logging.